Elastic Horizon: Mapping Collaboration

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Abstract

The artist talks about aims and outcomes of her recent research trip to CNMAT, UC Berkeley, with specific reference to the experience of collaborative arts, and the contrasts in research methods and objectives between the university environment and the underground studios she was working in.

Artist Statement

Shifting between the familiar and the abstract, *Elastic Horizon* extends the boundaries of the known world into a fantastic 'other' – a labyrinth of visual and aural experience.

Elastic Horizon is an interactive audiovisual installation, which invites the visitor to manipulate and transform images and sounds from the natural environment. Participant's actions within the space are interpreted, in real time, into a sequence of visual and aural effects. The number of people, their rate of movement and their location in the space all contribute to changes within the installation.

This project is the result of the collaborative work of Lissa Meridan (New Zealand) and Antonio Funiciello (Venezuela) and was supported by the Adam Art Gallery, Victoria University of Wellington, MagnumMac and B&H Visual Communication & Presentation Solutions.



Lissa Meridan (b. 1972) is currently Director of the Electroacoustic Music Studios at Victoria University of Wellington, where she also teaches instrumental composition, orchestration, counterpoint and acoustics. She is a committee member and webmaster for the Composers Assoc. of NZ and Vice President of the Australasian Computer Music Association.

Her primary artistic concern is with the recontextualisation of new music outside of the concert hall performance model, and this has manifested itself in multi-media collaborations with video and dance, gallery installations and interactive performances involving acoustic instruments and electronic media. Her research into performance practice in electroacoustic music has also led her into experimental turntablism and live video art – she has perfomed as *fierce angel* at events both in NZ, Venezuela and the USA. Recent recordings are available on the Atoll release Fanfares for the New Millienium, Sonic 2000: New Zealand Electronic Music and NZ Sonic Art Vol 2.